

Cover placeholder

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Introduction

Sauces

Chimmichurri

Ingredients: garlic, parsley, oregano, red wine vinegar, olive oil, salt, pepper Instructions: Chop all ingredients finely and mix together. Adjust seasoning to taste. Serve with grilled meats.

Spicy vinaigrette

Ingredients: red wine vinegar, olive oil, garlic, fresh chilli, green pepper, fresh tomato, onion, salt, pepper Instructions: Combine all ingredients in a bowl and whisk until well mixed. Adjust seasoning to taste.

Chapter One

Sauces + Sides



Pão de Queijo

Ingredients

- 500g Tapioca Starch (250g *Doce* / 250g *Azedo*)
- 250g Whole Milk (oat is fine)
- 100ml Water
- 100ml Vegetable Oil
- 10g Fine Salt
- 3 Eggs
- 150g Parmesan, finely grated
- 100g Mozzarella or mild cheddar, grated

Recipe

1. Scald: Bring milk, water, oil, and salt to a rolling boil. Pour immediately over the starch in a large bowl. Stir until a lumpy, sticky paste forms.
2. Cool: Allow the dough to cool for 15 minutes. It must be warm to the touch, not hot, to avoid scrambling the eggs.
3. Mix: Incorporate eggs one at a time, mixing thoroughly after each. Add the cheeses and knead until the dough is smooth, glossy, and uniform (*massa lisa*).
4. Form: Preheat oven to 190°C. Grease hands with oil and roll 30g balls. Space 5cm apart on a lined baking sheet.
5. Bake: Bake for 20–25 minutes. Remove when puffed and pale gold; over-baking results in a hard texture.

Hints

- Texture Science: Scalding causes starch gelatinization ($T \approx 65^{\circ}\text{C}$), creating the elastic matrix that traps steam for the rise.
- Handling: Never use wheat flour for dusting. If the dough is unmanageable, chill it for 30 minutes to reduce tackiness.
- Storage: Bake immediately or freeze raw balls. Bake from frozen at 180°C for 30 minutes.
- Starch Ratio: 100% *Doce* (Sweet) yields a dense, chewy roll; 100% *Azedo* (Sour) creates a hollow, tangy, and very airy puff.

Jollof Rice

Ingredients

- 200g Guanciale
- 2 cups Rice
- Red pepper
- Tomato
- Tomato paste
- 2 onions
- Scotch bonnet pepper
- Garlic
- Chicken stock
- Neutral oil (vegetable/sunflower)
- Herbs: thyme, bay leaf
- Spices: fennel, clove, ginger, paprika, tumeric
- Salt & peper

Recipe

1. Sauce base: blend the red pepper, 1 onion, tomato with some chicken stock. Fry off and put aside.
2. Spice blend: In the same pan, fry the remaining onion, garlic, tomato paste, scotch bonnet and spices until fragrant.
3. Combine: Add the rice to the spice mix & coat the grains. Add half of the sauce base, stock and water. Add the bay leaves.
4. Cook: Bring to the boil, then simmer on low heat, covered, until rice is cooked (15-20 mins).
5. Finish: Stir through the remaining sauce base, thyme, adjust seasoning and serve.

Recipe Development

- 31/12/25: Less spice, more tomato & pepper. More sauce base to serve on the side.

Hints

- Not too much spice or tumeric - Jollof is meant to be red, not orange!
- Excess sauce base can be served on the side.
- Add oil or butter towards the end of cooking, to prevent the rice becoming dry

Caldo Verde

Ingredients

- Beans

Recipe

1. Make

Hints

- Hint 1

Feijão

Ingredients

- Beans

Recipe

1. Make

Hints

- Hint 1

Mains

Cod with Morcilla



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Pão de Queijo

Ingredients

- 500g Cod

Recipe

1. **Scald:** Bring milk, water, oil, and salt to a rolling boil. Pour immediately over the starch in a large bowl. Stir until a lumpy, sticky paste forms.

Hints

- **Texture Science:** Scalding causes starch gelatinization ($T \approx 65^{\circ}C$), creating the elastic matrix that traps steam for the rise.

Lamb shank curry

Ingredients

- Beans

Recipe

1. Make

Hints

- Hint 1

Midweek grilled chicken

Ingredients

- Beans

Recipe

1. Make

Hints

- Hint 1

Short Ribs with Spiced Gravy

Ingredients

- Beans

Recipe

1. Make

Hints

- Hint 1

Puttanesca

Ingredients

- Beans

Recipe

1. Make

Hints

- Hint 1

Salad du Nice

Ingredients

- Beans

Recipe

1. Make

Hints

- Hint 1

Shakshuka with feta

Ingredients

- Beans

Recipe

1. Make

Hints

- Hint 1

Special Occasions

Baked Gammon with Pineapple Glaze

Ingredients

- Gammon
- Fresh pineapple - fibrous core removed
- Spices - cloves, cinnamon, nutmeg, or mixed spice
- Ginger - fresh and/or ground
- Honey
- Vinegar (mild)
- Marmelade

Instructions

1. Pressure cook the gammon for 20 minutes per 500g plus 20 minutes.
2. Blend the other ingredients to make a glaze.

Hints

- Buy the pineapple in advance, to make sure it's ripe.